

Music Appreciation





About the Course

This course aims to foster a love of music. Students begin by learning about and listening to common orchestral instruments. Then they spend the rest of the course with a few famous pieces of music that serve as a fun introduction for students with no prior exposure to classical music.

This topic is included in the following course(s): Music: Intro



Placement & Combining Tips

Suitable for Grades 1-3 if combining.



Scheduling

GRADE	SCHEDULE INFO.	BOOKS
1	Music Appreciation 1 time/week 10 min	A Child's Introduction to the Orchestra Playlist for Afternoon Listening and Selected Lessons

Sample Weekly View

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5
Music: Intro				
Sol-fa: Musical Games	Hymns & Spirituals Afternoon Listening		Folk Songs	Music Appreciation



Planning & Prep

Permission to print for non-commercial use. See Alveary group use policy to use lessons in a group context.

LINKS: Click text or scan the QR code in the top corner of the lesson plan pages to view online resources associated with the lessons.

Responsibility for previewing all links rests with the teacher. All links were checked at the time of publication; however, websites change frequently and may contain objectionable content. Please report broken links by contacting us through our website.

Music Appreciation

- ☐ Term 1: Download the audio files or bookmark the web page of A Child's Introduction to the Orchestra.
- ☐ Term 2: Learn how to pronounce Prokofiev and Camille Saint-Saens.
- ☐ Term 3: Art and music are paired together throughout this term. If teachers anticipate the resources might be overstimulating, Wild Symphony by Dan Brown is a good alternative (see Extra Helpings).



Books & Resources

For book rationales and purchase options, click the Book List link or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Book List Details](#)

Music Appreciation



Our Work: Grades 1-2



Hymns, Spirituals, & Folk Songs PDF



A Child's Introduction to the Orchestra



Playlist for Afternoon Listening and Selected Lessons



Supplies

For supply list details and basic supplies helpful to have on hand, click the links or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Basic Supplies](#)

∞ [View Supply List Details](#)

Music Appreciation



Household Items - Music Appreciation



Quick Links

Music Appreciation

∞ [Child's Introduction to the Orchestra](#)

∞ [Child's Introduction to the Orchestra \(Youtube\)](#)

∞ [How to Pronounce Prokofiev](#)

∞ [How to Pronounce Camille Saint-Saens](#)

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Music Appreciation

How To Teach



Recap

- Connect each lesson to the previous one for that topic.
- For music appreciation study, a recap might look like a brief discussion about the name or sound of the piece or instrument you listened to previously.
- For hymns and folk songs, this might be an effort to hum the melody or recite the words of the song you're currently learning.



Introduce

Prepare to listen to the day's musical selection or activity by inviting students to consider an interesting musical or historical idea in the lesson, perhaps a unique word, rhythm, instrument, or piece of historical background (usually included in lesson plans).



Listen & Practice

- Listen to the day's musical selection or practice the activity.
- Music Appreciation lessons will usually have you listen to a piece of music for 3-8 minutes. If students have a difficult time listening for the duration of the lesson, stop the music at their limit.
- Movement is always a great way to encourage students to engage with the music. Sometimes the lessons will provide a suggestion, but students may make up their own using their whole bodies or creating finger plays. They may also draw, color, or act out a dance with stuffed animals, dolls, or other figures.
- Hymn, folk song, or musical games will sometimes have you listen to a part of the song and then practice echoing back the melody and/or words.



Discuss

Let students share any thoughts or connections they have about the lesson.

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Term 1

WEEK 1	10m Music Appreciation - Lesson 1 <i>Woodwinds: Flute, Clarinet</i> → INTRO Instruments come in all shapes and sizes and make different sounds. The songs we listen to will describe instruments. → LISTEN, VIEW & NARRATE ∞ Audio Link: Antoinette the Clarinet ∞ Audio Link: Knute the Flute ∞ Image Link: Clarinet ∞ Image Link: Flute	• MUSIC JOURNAL Draw a clarinet or flute. • AFTERNOON LISTENING ∞ Audio Link: Young Person's Guide to the Orchestra "Introduction" Time Marker 0:00-3:49
WEEK 2	10m Music Appreciation - Lesson 2 <i>Woodwinds: Oboe, Bassoon</i> → RECAP Narrate about the woodwind family, naming and describing instruments. → LISTEN, VIEW & NARRATE Pretend you're a flute, clarinet, oboe, or bassoon. Move and sound like them. ∞ Audio Link: Bobo the Oboe ∞ Audio Link: Muldoon the Bassoon ∞ Image Link: Oboe ∞ Image Link: Bassoon	• AFTERNOON LISTENING ∞ Audio Link: YP's Guide to the Orchestra "Woodwinds" Time Marker 3:49-7:03
WEEK 3	10m Music Appreciation - Lesson 3 <i>Brass: Trumpets and Tubas</i> → RECAP Tell about your favorite woodwind. → LISTEN, VIEW & NARRATE How does a trumpet or tuba sound different from other instruments we've heard? ∞ Audio Link: Crumpet the Trumpet ∞ Audio Link: Poohbah the Tuba ∞ Image Link: Trumpet ∞ Image Link: Tuba	• AFTERNOON LISTENING ∞ Audio Link: YP's Guide to the Orchestra "Strings" Time Marker 7:03-11:45
WEEK 4	10m Music Appreciation - Lesson 4 <i>Brass: French Horn and Trombone</i> → INTRO While you listen to the music, march around, making your body match the sound and volume of the music. → LISTEN, VIEW & NARRATE ∞ Audio Link: Monsieur Forlorn the French Horn ∞ Audio Link: Mike Malone the Slide Trombone ∞ Image Link: French Horn ∞ Image Link: Slide Trombone	• AFTERNOON LISTENING ∞ Audio Link: YP's Guide to the Orchestra "Brass" Time Marker 11:45-14:19
WEEK 5	10m Music Appreciation - Lesson 5 <i>Strings</i> → RECAP Imitate the kind of sound a French horn or trombone makes. → LISTEN, VIEW & NARRATE ∞ Audio Link: Lucy Lynn the Violin ∞ Audio Link: Mello Fello the Cello ∞ Image Link: Violin ∞ Image Link: Cello	• MUSIC JOURNAL Draw a picture of yourself playing an instrument. • AFTERNOON LISTENING Listen to audios from the lesson.
WEEK 6	10m Music Appreciation - Lesson 6 <i>Strings (cont.)</i> → RECAP Name as many of the instruments as you can. → LISTEN, VIEW & NARRATE How does the viola sound different from the violin? The bass from the cello? ∞ Audio Link: Nola the Viola ∞ Audio Link: Lovelace the Bass ∞ Image Link: Viola ∞ Image Link: Bass ∞ Image Link: Violin, Viola, Cello, and Bass	• AFTERNOON LISTENING Listen to audios from the lesson.

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Term 1

WEEK 7 10m Music Appreciation - Lesson 7 <i>Percussion and Saxophone</i> → INTRO Percussion instruments are normally played by striking (some kind of beater [e.g., a mallet] or pedal-operated stick) or shaking. Can you think of any instruments that fit this description? → LISTEN, VIEW & NARRATE ∞ Audio Link: Peter Percussion ∞ Audio Link: Max the Saxophone ∞ Video Link: George Meets the Orchestra (6:01) ∞ Image Link: Saxophone	• AFTERNOON LISTENING ∞ Audio Link: YP's Guide to the Orchestra "Percussion" Time Marker 14:19-16:09
WEEK 8 10m Music Appreciation - Lesson 8 <i>Harp and Piano</i> → RECAP Tell what George learned in the last lesson. → LISTEN, VIEW & NARRATE While listening, move your body along with the music or pretend to be the conductor. ∞ Audio Link: Mort the Pianoforte ∞ Audio Link: Lady Harp ∞ Image Link: Pianoforte ∞ Image Link: Harp	• MUSIC JOURNAL Draw a picture of Lady Harp. • AFTERNOON LISTENING Listen to audios from the lesson.
WEEK 9 10m Music Appreciation - Lesson 9 <i>Voices</i> → INTRO How are people's voices also like the instruments we've studied? → LISTEN & DISCUSS Listen to the two songs. Did you hear which instrument was played with the singers in the second song? (piano) ∞ Audio Link: Cuckoo by Benjamin Britten ∞ Audio Link: Ee-Oh by Benjamin Britten	• AFTERNOON LISTENING ∞ Audio Link: Friday Afternoons by Britten
WEEK 10 10m Music Appreciation - Lesson 10 <i>Orchestra Together</i> → INTRO Pretend to be different instruments warming up to play in the orchestra. I'll guess which one you are imitating! How do you know when to start? (Conductor) → LISTEN, VIEW & NARRATE How does the sound of an orchestra differ from that of a single instrument? How does the first piece differ from the second one? ∞ Audio Link: The Orchestra: I. Allegro ∞ Audio Link: The Orchestra: II. Largo	• AFTERNOON LISTENING ∞ Audio Link: YP's Guide to the Orchestra "Orchestra Reassembled" Time Marker 16:09-20:05
WEEK 11 10m Music Appreciation - Lesson 11 <i>Orchestra Together (cont.)</i> → INTRO What do you think it would be like to play in an orchestra? What instruments do you think you might enjoy playing? → LISTEN & DISCUSS As you listen to the orchestra, pretend you are playing different instruments. Afterwards, tell all you know about the orchestra and the instruments in it. ∞ Audio Link: The Orchestra: III. Scherzo ∞ Audio Link: The Orchestra: IV. Andante	• AFTERNOON LISTENING Listen to audios from the lesson. • TERMINOLOGY Click on "Instruments of the Orchestra," then select "No Names" in the top left corner. Click on each instrument family for the student to name. ∞ Link: Instruments of the Orchestra Game
WEEK 12 10m Music Appreciation - Lesson 12 <i>Exam Week</i> → EXAMS There are no exams for this course.	

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Term 2

WEEK 1	10m Music Appreciation - Lesson 13 <i>Peter and the Wolf</i> → INTRO Today we are going to begin studying a new piece called Peter and the Wolf by Sergei Prokofiev. Prokofiev composed this piece to introduce children to the instruments in the orchestra. Itzhak Perlman, a world-famous violinist, narrates. → VIEW ∞ Video Link: Peter and the Wolf: I. Perlman Time Marker: 0:00-9:00 → DRAW Draw or tell about the characters and instruments that you met today.	• AFTERNOON LISTENING A flute plays the bird in Peter and the Wolf. Watch how fast this flutist plays. ∞ Video Link: Flight of the Bumblebee by Rimsky-Korsakov
WEEK 2	10m Music Appreciation - Lesson 14 <i>Peter and the Wolf (cont.)</i> → RECAP Tell what you remember from last week. → VIEW ∞ Video Link: Peter and the Wolf: I. Perlman Time Marker: 9:00-18:00 → NARRATE Use stuffed animals or puppets to act out the story.	• AFTERNOON LISTENING An oboe represents the duck in Peter and the Wolf. Watch the man in the black suit play the oboe in this piece. ∞ Video Link: Mozart's Oboe Concerto
WEEK 3	10m Music Appreciation - Lesson 15 <i>Peter and the Wolf (cont.)</i> → RECAP Tell about the instruments that are in the story. → VIEW ∞ Video Link: Peter and the Wolf: I. Perlman Time Marker: 18:00-End	• MUSIC JOURNAL Draw a picture of one of the characters in the story and the instrument that represents the character. Alternatively, students might paint what the music feels like or imitate the character and their instrument. • AFTERNOON LISTENING Big drums, called timpani, represent The Hunters. Watch at least a few minutes of this video to see how timpani are played. ∞ Video Link: Fantasia for Timpani
WEEK 4	10m Music Appreciation - Lesson 16 <i>Peter and the Wolf Version Two</i> → INTRO Today, we will listen to a different recording of Peter and the Wolf narrated by Leonard Bernstein, a famous conductor. → VIEW ∞ Video Link: Peter and the Wolf: L. Bernstein Time Marker: 0:00-8:00 → NARRATE How is this recording different from the previous one?	• AFTERNOON LISTENING ∞ Audio Link: About Sergei Prokofiev
WEEK 5	10m Music Appreciation - Lesson 17 <i>Peter and the Wolf V2 (cont.)</i> → VIEW ∞ Video Link: Peter and the Wolf: L. Bernstein Time Marker: 8:00 - 18:00 → NARRATE Did you notice any ways this recording is different from the last one?	• AFTERNOON LISTENING ∞ Video Link: Peter and the Wolf: L. Bernstein
WEEK 6	10m Music Appreciation - Lesson 18 <i>Carnival of the Animals</i> → INTRO Today, we will listen to a new composition called Carnival of the Animals by Camille Saint-Saens. → LISTEN Stop at the end of each animal & name the next animal for students: Royal March of Lion, Hens &	• AFTERNOON LISTENING Carnival of the Animals or other music (see Extra Helpings for suggestions).

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	Roosters, Wild Donkeys, Tortoises, & Elephant. ∞ Audio Link: Carnival of the Animals Version 1 Time Marker: 0:00-7:45	
WEEK 7	10m Music Appreciation - Lesson 19 <i>Carnival of the Animals: Kangaroos through Cuckoo</i> → RECAP What were some of the animals we heard last week? → LISTEN This week, we are going to hear movements called Kangaroos, Aquarium, Characters with Long Ears, and The Cuckoo in the Depths of the Woods. What do you think the animals with long ears are? What kinds of fish do you imagine? ∞ Audio Link: Carnival of the Animals Version 1 Time Marker: 7:46-14:21	• AFTERNOON LISTENING Carnival of the Animals or other music (see Extra Helpings for suggestions).
WEEK 8	10m Music Appreciation - Lesson 20 <i>Carnival of the Animals: Aviary through Finale</i> → LISTEN This week, we are going to hear movements entitled Aviary, Pianists, Fossils, The Swan, and The Finale. March, walk, creep, or dance with the music. ∞ Audio Link: Carnival of the Animals Version 1 Time Marker: 14:22 to End → NARRATE What instruments did you hear? How did each movement sound to you? (happy, sad, etc.)	• AFTERNOON LISTENING Carnival of the Animals or other music (see Extra Helpings for suggestions).
WEEK 9	10m Music Appreciation - Lesson 21 <i>Carnival of the Animals: Lion through Tortoises</i> → RECAP Tell about the Swan movement. Do you think it would be better for a dance or a march? → LISTEN Today we're going to listen to a new version of Carnival of the Animals. ∞ Video Link: Carnival of the Animals Version 2 Time Marker: 0:00-6:29 → DISCUSS Did you notice anything different about this version from the other one we listened to?	• MUSIC JOURNAL Hum the tune of one of your favorite animals/movements and draw the animal in your Music Journal. Alternatively, students might act out their animal. • AFTERNOON LISTENING Carnival of the Animals or other music (see Extra Helpings for suggestions).
WEEK 10	10m Music Appreciation - Lesson 22 <i>Carnival of the Animals: Elephant through Cuckoo</i> → LISTEN & PRACTICE Act out the music with your stuffed animals or by yourself. ∞ Video Link: Carnival of the Animals Version 2 Time Marker: 6:29-15:13	• AFTERNOON LISTENING Carnival of the Animals or other music (see Extra Helpings for suggestions).
WEEK 11	10m Music Appreciation - Lesson 23 <i>Carnival of the Animals: Aviary through Finale</i> → RECAP Can you hum the tune of your favorite animal? → LISTEN, VIEW & NARRATE Listen to your favorite section of Carnival of the Animals or Peter and the Wolf. ∞ Video Link: Carnival of the Animals Version 2 ∞ Video Link: Peter and the Wolf: L. Bernstein	• AFTERNOON LISTENING Carnival of the Animals or other music (see Extra Helpings for suggestions).
WEEK 12	10m Music Appreciation - Lesson 24 <i>10m Music Appreciation - Lesson 24</i> Exam Week → EXAMS There are no exams for this course.	

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Term 3

WEEK 1	10m Music Appreciation - Lesson 25 <i>The Flight of the Bumblebee</i> → INTRO We'll be listening to a variety of works this term. Look at the artwork, then read the questions related to each piece. Listen to each piece several times. Some students may not need to have the artwork and questions available during listening, but others might. Allow them to engage in whatever way is best for them. Can you hear the different features in the music? → LISTEN, VIEW & NARRATE ∞ Audio Link: Flight of the Bumblebee ∞ Art Print Link: Chrysanthemums Hiroshige • Can you hear the bees buzzing above the flowers? • What instruments do you hear? Which ones describe the bee?	★ TEACHER TIP These lessons are inspired by the Metropolitan Museum of Art's book "Can You Hear It?" which is linked in Extra Helpings but is currently out of print. If you are able to obtain the book, you can use it with these lessons as it puts the art and music selections in one place and provides information about instruments. • AFTERNOON LISTENING Choose music from the lesson or see Extra Helpings for more suggestions.
WEEK 2	10m Music Appreciation - Lesson 26 <i>The Four Seasons: Winter</i> → LISTEN, VIEW & NARRATE Look at the artwork and read the questions below. Then listen to the piece several times with them in mind and discuss. ∞ Audio Link: Vivaldi's Winter Allegro ∞ Art Print Link: Winterscape Brueghel • Can you hear "A solo violin plays the skater, using quick notes to show the gliding motion" (Can You Hear It?). • Can you hear the string instruments playing scales going up and down quickly? What do you think they might be showing? Maybe it's the wind or someone falling down on skates!	• AFTERNOON LISTENING ∞ Video Link: Vivaldi's Winter (Complete)
WEEK 3	10m Music Appreciation - Lesson 27 <i>An American in Paris</i> → LISTEN, VIEW & NARRATE Look at the artwork and read the questions below. Then listen to the piece several times with them in mind and discuss. ∞ Audio Link: American in Paris Time Marker: 0:15-1:20 ∞ Art Print Link: Avenue du Bois Dongen • What city sounds do you hear in this piece? • Can you hear the horses' hooves clopping? The woodblock makes that sound!	• AFTERNOON LISTENING ∞ Video Link: American in Paris by Gershwin (Complete)
WEEK 4	10m Music Appreciation - Lesson 28 <i>The Aquarium</i> → LISTEN, VIEW & NARRATE Look at the artwork and read the questions below. Then listen to the piece several times with them in mind and discuss. ∞ Audio Link: Carnival of the Animals: Aquarium ∞ Art Print Link: Ocean Life Schussele • Can you hear the fish in the water? What instruments do you think play them? (mostly flutes and violins)	• AFTERNOON LISTENING Choose music from the lesson or see Extra Helpings for more suggestions.
WEEK 5	10m Music Appreciation - Lesson 29 <i>Dance of the Knights</i> → LISTEN, VIEW & NARRATE Look at the artwork and read the questions. Then listen to the piece several times with them in mind and discuss. ∞ Audio Link: Romeo and Juliet: Dance of the Knights Time Marker: 0:00-1:40 ∞ Art Print Link: Tournament Book Unknown • Try marching to this piece. • Can you hear the armies fighting? What instruments are making all the noise? (lots of brass instruments and drums)	• AFTERNOON LISTENING Choose music from the lesson or see Extra Helpings for more suggestions.
WEEK 6	10m Music Appreciation - Lesson 30 <i>Dance of the Sugar Plum</i> → LISTEN, VIEW & NARRATE Look at the artwork and read the questions. Then listen to the piece several times with them in mind and discuss. ∞ Audio Link: Dance of the Sugar Plum Fairy ∞ Art Print Link: The Christmas Tree Varin	• AFTERNOON LISTENING ∞ Video Link: The Nutcracker (Complete) or try this narrated version for those who need help following the story: ∞ Audio Link: Nutcracker with Jim Weiss

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	• Can you hear the violins playing little fairy steps with little plucking sounds? • What kind of dancing do you think they're doing?	
WEEK 7 10m Music Appreciation - Lesson 31 <i>The Four Seasons: Spring</i>	→ LISTEN, VIEW & NARRATE Look at the artwork and read the questions below. Then listen to the piece several times with them in mind and discuss. ∞ Audio Link: Vivaldi's Spring Time Marker: 0:00-2:08 ∞ Art Print Link: Mountain Torrent Ruisdael • What season do you think this piece describes musically? (Don't tell the name of the piece until the end!) • Can you hear the birds? (violin) What about a mountain stream? (the whole violin section) Thunder? (lots of string instruments on one note)	• AFTERNOON LISTENING ∞ Video Link: Vivaldi's Spring (afternoon)
WEEK 8 10m Music Appreciation - Lesson 32 <i>Fossils</i>	→ LISTEN, VIEW & NARRATE Look at the artwork and read the questions. Then listen to the piece several times with them in mind and discuss. ∞ Audio Link: Carnival of the Animals: Fossils ∞ Art Print Link: Fossils • Can you hear the old fossil bones rattling around? • Can you hear "Twinkle, Twinkle, Little Star" on the piano? The book Can You Hear It says, "This is one of the composer's jokes - 'Twinkle, Twinkle' is an old tune that will never die, and so it, too, is something of a skeleton!"	• AFTERNOON LISTENING Listen to Carnival of the Animals from last term or see Extra Helpings for more suggestions. ∞ Video Link: Carnival of the Animals
WEEK 9 10m Music Appreciation - Lesson 33 <i>Comic Duet for Two Cats</i>	→ LISTEN, VIEW & NARRATE Look at the artwork and read the questions. Then listen to the piece several times with them in mind and discuss. ∞ Audio Link: Comic Duet for Two Cats ∞ Art Print Link: Little White Kitties: Into Mischief Currier and Ives • What animal do you think you'll hear in this piece based on the art? • Can you hear them hiss and purr?	• AFTERNOON LISTENING Choose music from the lesson or see Extra Helpings for more suggestions.
WEEK 10 10m Music Appreciation - Lesson 34 <i>Billy the Kid: Gun Battle</i>	→ LISTEN, VIEW & NARRATE Look at the artwork and read the questions. Then listen to the piece several times with them in mind and discuss. ∞ Audio Link: Billy the Kid Gun Battle ∞ Art Print Link: On the Southern Plains Remington • Listen for the kettledrums, which are the guns! • Can you hear the outlaw running away? The trumpet plays his part.	• AFTERNOON LISTENING Choose music from the lesson or see Extra Helpings for more suggestions.
WEEK 11 10m Music Appreciation - Lesson 35 <i>The Four Seasons: Summer</i>	→ LISTEN, VIEW & NARRATE Look at the artwork and read the questions. Then listen to the piece several times with them in mind and discuss. ∞ Audio Link: Vivaldi's Summer ∞ Art Print Link: View from Mount Holyoke, Northampton, Massachusetts, after a Thunderstorm—The Oxbow Cole • What kind of weather is happening in this piece? • Can you hear the violins describing the trees falling down? • Do you hear any other animals in the storm?	• AFTERNOON LISTENING ∞ Video Link: Vivaldi's Summer (afternoon)
WEEK 12 10m Music Appreciation - Lesson 36 <i>Exam Week</i>	→ EXAMS There are no exams for this course.	• AFTERNOON LISTENING Enjoy the one season by Vivaldi you haven't heard yet: Fall. ∞ Video Link: Vivaldi's Fall